

Digital Mapping Project Plan:

Li Bai's Poetry and Life Journey

Project pitch

A small digital humanities project that uses Li Bai's life journey to geographically illustrate the relationship between poetry and place.

Introduction

Li Bai is one of the greatest poets in Chinese literary history and an important representative poet of the Tang Dynasty. He is famous for his rich imagination, romantic style, and strong emotional expression. His poems often describe nature, friendship, travel, wine, freedom, and personal ideals. Because of his great literary achievement, Li Bai has had a lasting influence on Chinese literature and culture.

Li Bai's life was also closely connected with travel. He visited many places during his lifetime, and these journeys influenced his poetry in different ways. Different locations and life experiences shaped the themes, emotions, and imagery in his works. Therefore, Li Bai is a suitable subject for a digital humanities project.

This project aims to explore the relationship between Li Bai's life journey and the content of his poetry. It plans to combine map-based visualization with related poems to show how his travels and experiences are connected to his poetic creation. By linking important places in Li Bai's life with his poems, the project hopes to present his life and works in a more direct, visual, and engaging way.



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Research Questions, Objectives & Method

Research Questions (≥2)

RQ1: How are Li Bai's life journeys reflected in the themes and content of his poetry?

RQ2: How can map-based visualization help show the relationship between Li Bai's travel experiences and his poetic works?

RQ3: What changes in themes, emotions, or imagery can be identified in Li Bai's poems across different places and stages of his life?

Objectives

- 1、To examine the relationship between Li Bai's life journey and the content of his poetry.
- 2、To present Li Bai's important travel locations and related poems through map-based visualization.
- 3、To analyze changes in themes, emotions, and imagery in Li Bai's poems across different places and stages of his life.

Pilot corpus (planned)
8 selected poems chosen for clear place references such as Chang'an, Jinling, Lushan, Baidicheng, Yangzhou, and Emei-related locations.

Digital considerations
Use CSV/XLSX as master data;
export map layers in KML/KMZ for sharing, reuse, and later extension.
Interoperability: KML/KMZ is chosen as it follows the OGC international standard, ensuring the data remains platform-independent and fully functional on global GIS tools like Google Earth.

Method & Workflow (Prototype)

1 Collect texts
Chinese Text Project / digital anthologies



2 Select pilot poems
choose texts with clear place references



3 Extract & normalise
ancient place → modern match



4 Build dataset
CSV / XLSX fields for mapping

A dedicated Place_Name_EN field will be included in the CSV master data to ensure the project is accessible to non-Chinese speaking researchers and evaluators.



5 Map & analyse
My Maps + basic frequency chart



6 Team Engagement Tracking
Integrate a dashboard to visualize group contribution and ensure transparent collaboration.

Output: one compact DH proposal with an interactive map concept, a small structured dataset, and a basic frequency visual.

Prototype Visuals & Preliminary Sources

Graphic 1: Li Bai trajectory map reference (dataset inspiration)

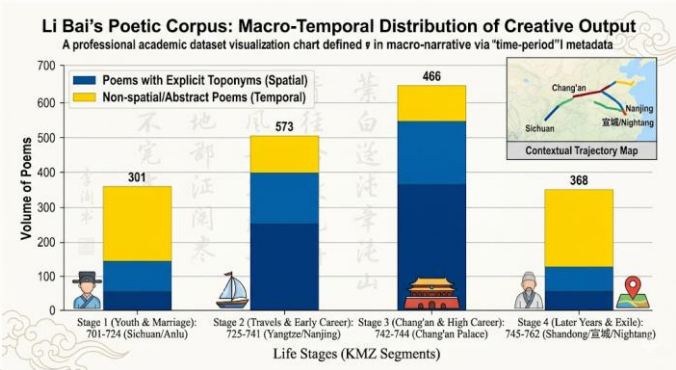


Use the trajectory/KML reference as a visual model. The final prototype will plot a smaller pilot corpus of poem-based place names on a cleaner custom map.

Note: The map markers represent approximately 200 key locations from Li Bai's life trajectory. In the final project, these will be translated and cross-referenced with modern English geographic names to ensure accessibility for a global audience.

Sample poem	Place name	Modern match
Yellow Crane Tower... to Guangling	Guangling	Yangzhou, Jiangsu
Viewing the Waterfall at Mount Lu	Lushan	Jiujiang, Jiangxi
Early Departure from Baidi City	Baidicheng	Chongqing

Graphic 2: Number of poems by Li Bai during his time period



Planned pilot poems (examples)

Seeing Meng Haoran off at Yellow Crane Tower to Guangling;
Early Departure from Baidi City; Viewing the Waterfall at Mount Lu;
selected Jinling and Chang'an poems.

Preliminary sources (websites / datasets / standards)

- Chinese Text Project (digital texts)
- Li Bai trajectory KML/KMZ blog dataset reference
- Google My Maps Help (custom map workflow)
- OGC KML Standard
- QGIS (optional open-source extension)

Interactive Feature Note

The final website will feature a dedicated sidebar/section for the Interactive Engagement Tool to ensure transparent teamwork and track group contributions in real-time.